

TAB 4



Board of Education Report

File #: Rep-022-24/25, **Version:** 1

Project Approval for the James A. Garfield High School Major Modernization Project
September 10, 2024
Facilities Services Division

Action Proposed:

Approve the proposed James A. Garfield High School Major Modernization Project (Project).

Authorize the Chief Procurement Officer and/or the Chief Facilities Executive and/or their designee(s) to execute all reasonable instruments to implement the proposed Project, including budget modifications and the purchase of equipment and materials.

The Office of Environmental Health and Safety's (OEHS) evaluation of the proposed Project resulted in the preparation of a Mitigated Negative Declaration (MND). Pursuant to the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA) Guidelines, staff is requesting the Board of Education (Board) approve the proposed Project so that construction activities can commence at a later date. The proposed action may only be considered after the Board adopts the MND prepared by OEHS in compliance with CEQA and State CEQA Guidelines for the proposed Project.

Background:

On November 16, 2021, the Board approved project definition for site due diligence, planning, and feasibility activities necessary to propose scope recommendations, budget, and schedule for the proposed Project. Subsequently, on November 15, 2022, the Board approved the project redefinition for the proposed Project to begin the environmental review, design, procurement, and other activities necessary to implement the proposed Project.

The proposed Project is located within the 19.3-acre school campus at 5101 East 6th Street in East Los Angeles, an unincorporated area within Los Angeles County (Board District 2, Region East). James A. Garfield High School (School) opened in 1925. All existing buildings were constructed between 1925 and 2013. The campus has been identified eligible as a historic district due to its students' participation in the 1968 civil rights movement known as the "Blowouts". All buildings present during the Blowouts are included in the historic district, however particular significance is placed on the football field and its bleachers. As of the 2023-2024 Electronic Capacity Assessment Review, the School served approximately 2,220 students in grades 9 through 12.

The proposed Project will construct new facilities, including a four-story Classroom Building with 31 general and specialty classrooms and support spaces, library, and administration space. The proposed Project also includes exterior painting for all remaining buildings and structures at the School, and limited modernization of existing structures and infrastructure upgrades to ensure compliance with the Americans with Disabilities Act. The proposed Project will maintain the School's current capacity and total number of classrooms (84 classrooms).

The proposed Project includes the demolition of two permanent buildings (Parking Garage & Classroom Building 100 and Library & Classroom Building 200), two relocatable buildings, and a second-story pedestrian bridge. Interim facilities will be installed to allow the School to remain operational and minimize impact during construction.

The proposed Project also includes utility upgrades; Internet Protocol (IP) convergence; a new parking lot; new outdoor learning environments; the removal and replacement of trees; landscaping and irrigation; hardscaping; fencing, gates, and site furnishings.

Expected Outcomes:

Approval of the proposed Project will permit construction activities to be undertaken once the Division of the State Architect (DSA) approval is secured. Construction activities related to the construction of new buildings are anticipated to begin in the first quarter of 2026, and site/utility/interim facilities activities may begin in advance of this work, in an earlier phase. Construction is anticipated to be completed in the third quarter of 2029.

Board Options and Consequences:

Adoption of staff's proposal will permit Los Angeles Unified to proceed with the construction of the proposed Project after DSA approval is secured. If the proposed action is not adopted, staff will be unable to proceed with construction activities. As a result, the School will continue to operate with aging, deteriorating, and outdated buildings and grounds. Furthermore, students, staff and the community will not benefit from the significant facilities improvements that will be undertaken as part of the proposed Project.

Policy Implications:

This action helps facilitate the Facilities Services Division Strategic Execution Plan and supports the goals and objectives of the School Upgrade Program (SUP). The proposed action advances Los Angeles Unified's 2022-2026 Strategic Plan, Pillar 4 Operational Effectiveness, Modernizing Infrastructure by upgrading facilities to support the instructional program.

Budget Impact:

The proposed action does not have a budget impact as the Board previously authorized funding for the proposed Project when it adopted the project definition. The current budget for the proposed Project is \$150,886,100. The budget is being increased to reflect an updated forecast of all anticipated project costs, including for a design-build contract, testing, inspection and management fees, and current pricing for the purchase of furniture and equipment. A budget modification in the amount of \$9,547,940 will be required to support the implementation of the Project, increasing the project budget to \$160,434,040. The proposed Project is funded by Bond Program funds targeted in the SUP for major modernizations, upgrades, and reconfigurations to school campuses.

Student Impact:

The proposed Project will help ensure that the students attending the school are provided with safe and updated facilities that support learning.

Equity Impact:

The intent of the major modernization project is to address buildings and grounds that pose a safety concern and have the greatest need for upgrades with emphasis placed on seismic safety, reducing Los Angeles Unified's reliance on relocatable buildings, and addressing the most critical/severe physical conditions. While the proposed Project is extensive in nature, less critical items may not be addressed. This approach allows Los

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Angeles Unified to reach more schools with the limited funding available.

Issues and Analysis:

OEHS evaluated the proposed Project to determine potential impacts on the environment in accordance with CEQA and State CEQA Guidelines. This evaluation, as documented in the Initial Study (IS), resulted in the preparation of an MND. The MND was circulated for a 30-day public review period from April 17, 2024, to May 17, 2024. The analysis documented in the IS/MND found that the proposed Project would have no impacts or less than significant environmental impacts as a result of construction or operation of the proposed Project. Pursuant to State CEQA Guidelines, prior to the proposed Project proceeding into construction, the Board must adopt the MND and subsequently must approve the proposed Project.

Attachments:

None

Informatives:

None

Submitted:

08/09/24

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RESPECTFULLY SUBMITTED,


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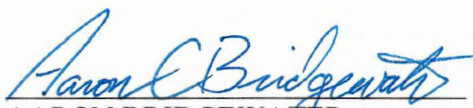

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☒ Approved as to form.

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